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The concepts in this book describe natural patterns of thinking, organization, and memory.

They are not a method, system, or guarantee of performance.

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Preface

This book began with a simple question:

Why does thinking feel clear in some environments
and heavy in others?

Over the years, I noticed that clarity did not come from tools,
systems, or techniques.

It came from conditions—

from the way information was placed,

from the weight of the desk,

from the quietness of the shelf,

and from whether the mind had room to move.

The Natural Brain grew out of these observations.

It is not a productivity method.

It is not a framework to follow.

It is a way of seeing how the mind works

when it is not overloaded.

The ideas in this book come from everyday life:

from notebooks filled with unfinished thoughts,

from desks that became too heavy,

from shelves that held what the mind no longer needed to carry.

Over time, a pattern became clear.

Thought begins loosely,

becomes clearer through action,
and settles into memory when it is ready.
This book describes that movement—
and the environments that support it.
If these pages help you notice
when your thinking feels natural,
and when it does not,
then this book has done its work.

S. Hara

Overview Summary

This book explores how the human brain naturally thinks, remembers, and decides when it is not overloaded by tools, systems, or constant demands for control.

Modern information environments are efficient, fast, and powerful.

At the same time, they often place continuous cognitive load on the user—fragmenting attention, weakening judgment, and interrupting the natural flow of thought.

The Natural Brain does not introduce a new productivity method or organizational system.

Instead, it examines everyday interfaces—such as notebooks, desks, shelves, and digital environments—and asks a simpler question:

What conditions allow the human brain to work calmly and sustainably?

Through familiar objects and practices, this book describes how structure can support thinking without dominating it, and how tools can hold information so the brain does not have to.

The focus is not on optimization, speed, or performance, but on restoring balance between control and delegation, awareness and automation, structure and freedom.

This book is intended to be read naturally, without technical knowledge.

Its purpose is to help readers recognize when their thinking environment feels natural—and when it does not.

Terminology

This glossary explains the key terms used in this book.

These are not technical definitions, but practical meanings for everyday thinking and work.

Natural

A state in which thinking, deciding, and remembering happen without strain or force.

What feels sustainable over long periods of time.

Unnatural

A state created when tools or habits overload attention, fragment thought, or require constant compensation.

Natural Brain

The human brain functioning at its best—able to think, remember, and decide calmly when information is handled at a human pace and scale.

Interface

Anything that stands between a person and information.

This includes tools, screens, notebooks, desks, and organizational habits.

Load

The mental effort required to understand, manage, or retrieve information.

When load is high, thinking becomes shallow or reactive.

Control

The act of consciously managing information, tools, or behavior.

Useful in small amounts, exhausting when constant.

Delegation

Letting tools or structures hold information so the brain does not have to.

Healthy delegation reduces mental load instead of increasing it.

Awareness

The ability to notice what one is doing, thinking, or feeling without interruption.

Awareness declines when interfaces demand constant attention.

Judgment

The capacity to decide what matters and what does not.

Judgment weakens when information is fragmented or lacks context.

Structure

An arrangement that supports thinking without needing active maintenance.

Good structure is often unnoticed because it feels natural.

Flow of Thought

The natural progression of thinking when interruptions, friction, and unnecessary decisions are minimized.

Traditional

Practices developed before constant digital mediation.

Not outdated—simply tested through long-term human use.

Modern

Tools and systems designed for speed, scale, and efficiency.

Useful, but often indifferent to human cognitive limits.

System

In this book, a system refers to a supportive environment rather than a rigid method.

It should serve thinking, not dictate it.

Tool

Anything used to record, organize, or access information.

A good tool reduces effort; a bad tool creates dependency.

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Chapter 1 — What is the Natural Brain

The human brain was not designed for the speed, scale, and constant stimulation of modern information environments. It was shaped by slower rhythms—by tasks that unfolded over time, by objects that stayed where they were placed, and by environments that did not demand continuous attention. Today, information moves faster than the mind can naturally follow.

Tools notify, systems update, and interfaces ask for decisions at every moment.

Even when these tools are helpful, they often create a subtle pressure:

a sense that the mind must keep up, manage, and control more than it comfortably can.

The Natural Brain refers to the brain functioning at its best—thinking, remembering, and deciding at a human pace.

It is not a special state or a technique.

It is simply the condition in which the mind works without strain.

When the environment is calm, the mind becomes calm.

When information is arranged in a way that matches how the brain naturally moves, thinking becomes clearer and more continuous.

This book begins with a simple observation:

The brain works well when it does not have to fight its environment.

Modern tools are powerful, but they often require the user to adapt to them—

to remember where things are stored, to manage notifications, to maintain systems, or to compensate for friction that did not exist before.

The Natural Brain approach reverses this relationship.

Instead of asking the mind to adapt to tools, it asks:

How can tools and structures adapt to the mind?

To explore this question, the book looks at familiar objects—notebooks, desks, shelves, and digital folders.

These objects have been used for centuries, long before modern systems existed.

They reflect a traditional way of working:

placing things where they naturally belong, letting them settle over time, and returning to them when needed.

The Natural Brain is not about efficiency or optimization.

It is about restoring the conditions under which the mind can think clearly.

Three ideas guide this approach:

- Thinking needs space.

When the mind is crowded, thought becomes shallow.

- Memory needs stability.

When information moves too quickly, it cannot settle.

- Decisions need context.

When attention is fragmented, judgment weakens.

These principles are not new.

They are part of how people have always worked when they were not overwhelmed by tools or interruptions.

The Natural Brain is simply a way of noticing these conditions again.

In the chapters that follow, the book introduces a gentle three-layer model—

Notebook, Desktop, and Bookshelf—that mirrors the natural movement of thought:

- where ideas begin,
- where decisions are made,
- and where knowledge eventually rests.

This model is not a system to follow.

It is a way of seeing how information behaves when it is allowed to move naturally.

The goal is not to control the mind, but to support it.

Not to manage information, but to let it settle.

Not to work faster, but to work in a way that feels sustainable.

The Natural Brain is already present in everyone.

This book simply provides the conditions for it to reappear.

Chapter 2 — The Natural Data Base System

The Natural Data Base System, or NDB, describes how information moves through the mind when it is allowed to follow its natural course.

It is not a digital system, nor a method to be learned.

It is a way of seeing how ideas begin, develop, and eventually settle—

a pattern that has existed long before computers, folders, or productivity tools.

NDB is built on a simple observation:

Information behaves like thought.

It moves, pauses, and rests.

When information is placed in environments that match these movements,

the mind no longer needs to manage it.

It can think freely, without strain.

To describe this movement, NDB uses a gentle three-layer model:

- Notebook — where ideas begin
- Desktop — where decisions are made
- Bookshelf — where knowledge rests

These layers are not categories to maintain.

They are environments that support the natural flow of thought.

The Notebook — Where Ideas Begin

Ideas rarely appear fully formed.

They begin as fragments, questions, or impressions—
things that need space rather than structure.

The Notebook is the place for this early stage.

It holds active thoughts, unfinished notes, and anything that is
still taking shape.

Nothing in the Notebook needs to be organized.

Nothing needs to be named perfectly.

The only requirement is that ideas have a place to land.

When the mind knows where to put a thought,
it becomes easier to think the next one.

The Desktop — Where Decisions Are Made

The Desktop is the surface on which work happens.

It is not a storage area, and it is not a place for information to
accumulate.

On a physical desk, only the items needed for the current task are
present.

Everything else stays in drawers, shelves, or notebooks.

The same principle applies here.

The Desktop contains four natural states of work:

- IN TRAY — things that have arrived
- ON DESK — things being worked on
- ON SIDE — things waiting
- FILED — things that are done

These states do not manage information.

They simply reflect what the mind is doing.

A clear desk supports clear decisions.

A heavy desk pulls thinking down.

This is the essence of the Zero Gravity Desk:

a workspace that carries no weight.

The Bookshelf — Where Knowledge Rests

As ideas mature, they no longer need active shaping.

They settle into memory, becoming stable and quiet.

The Bookshelf represents this stage.

It contains four natural layers:

- Works — materials still in motion
- Record — factual traces of what happened
- Reference — information that supports thinking
- Archives — long-term, enduring knowledge

These layers are not rules.

They are the way information naturally settles over time.

The Bookshelf is not a place to manage.

It is a place to return to.

The Transition Principle

The movement from Notebook to Bookshelf is not a decision.

It is a shift.

When an idea no longer needs active attention,

it naturally moves toward rest.

This is the Transition Principle:

information settles when it is ready.

No schedule is required.

No rule determines the timing.

The mind simply recognizes when something has become quiet.

The 1-1-1 Principle

To keep ideas continuous and easy to return to,

NDB uses a gentle guideline:

One Idea, One Folder, One Master File.

This principle prevents scattering.

It keeps each idea in a single place,

allowing it to grow in a straight line rather than in fragments.

The 1-1-1 Principle is not a system.

It is a traditional way of working—
simple, calm, and sustainable.

Why NDB Works

NDB does not ask the mind to adapt to tools.

It asks tools to adapt to the mind.

It works because it mirrors how thought naturally moves:

- Ideas begin loosely
- Decisions require clarity
- Knowledge settles slowly

When information is placed in environments that match these
movements,

the mind becomes lighter.

Thinking becomes continuous.

Judgment becomes clearer.

NDB is not a method to follow.

It is a way to restore the conditions under which the mind works
best.

Chapter 3 — Notebook

The Notebook is the beginning of thought.

It is the place where ideas appear before they have shape, order, or purpose.

Most thinking does not start with clarity.

It begins as fragments—half-formed sentences, loose impressions, or questions that do not yet have answers.

The Notebook exists to hold these early forms of thought.

It is not a place for organization.

It is not a place for structure.

It is simply a place where ideas can land without pressure.

When the mind knows it has a place to put a thought, it becomes easier to think the next one.

The Nature of Early Thought

Early thought is fragile.

If it is forced into structure too soon, it breaks.

If it is judged too quickly, it disappears.

The Notebook protects this early stage.

It allows ideas to remain unfinished for as long as they need.

Nothing in the Notebook must be correct, complete, or polished.

A note can be a sentence, a list, a sketch, or a single word.

The form does not matter.

What matters is that the idea has a home.

CURRENT and PREVIOUS

The Notebook has two natural states:

- CURRENT — thoughts that are alive
- PREVIOUS — thoughts that have quieted

This distinction is not a system.

It is simply a reflection of how the mind works.

CURRENT holds what is active:

today's ideas, ongoing notes, things still in motion.

PREVIOUS holds what has settled:

yesterday's thoughts, completed notes, things no longer being shaped.

Nothing moves from CURRENT to PREVIOUS by rule.

It moves when the mind no longer needs to hold it.

This is the first expression of the Transition Principle.

Why the Notebook Must Stay Light

A Notebook becomes heavy when it tries to do too much.

If it becomes a place for tasks, storage, or long-term information, it loses its purpose.

The Notebook must remain light so that thought can remain light.

A heavy Notebook slows thinking.

A light Notebook supports it.

This is why NDB separates the Notebook from the Desktop and the Bookshelf.

Each layer has its own role, and the Notebook's role is to begin—not to finish.

Naming in the Notebook

Notebook items begin with a date.

This is not for organization.

It is for clarity.

A date tells the mind,

“This thought belongs to a moment.”

It also makes Notebook items easy to distinguish from Bookshelf items,

which rarely begin with dates.

A typical Notebook entry might look like:

The name does not need to be perfect.

It only needs to be recognizable.

The Notebook is not a place for precision.

It is a place for movement.

The 1-1-1 Principle in the Notebook

The Notebook is where the 1-1-1 Principle begins.

When an idea starts to grow, it receives its own folder and its own master file.

This keeps the idea continuous.

It prevents scattering.

It allows the idea to develop in a single line rather than in fragments.

The 1-1-1 Principle is not a rule.

It is a gentle way of keeping ideas whole.

When a Notebook Item Matures

Some ideas stay in the Notebook for minutes.

Others stay for months.

There is no schedule.

There is no requirement to move anything.

When an idea becomes stable—

when it no longer needs active shaping—

it naturally moves toward the Bookshelf.

This is the Transition Principle in its purest form.

The Notebook begins the movement.

The Bookshelf completes it.

The Desktop supports the middle.

The Role of the Notebook in Daily Life

The Notebook is the most human part of NDB.

It reflects how people naturally think:

- loosely
- gradually
- in fragments
- without certainty
- without structure at first

The Notebook does not try to change this.

It simply gives it a place.

When the Notebook is used gently,
thinking becomes easier.

Ideas become clearer.

The mind becomes lighter.

The Notebook is not a tool.

It is a space—

a space where thought can begin without pressure.

Chapter 4 — Desktop

The Desktop is the surface where decisions are made.

It is not a place for storage, and it is not a place for information to accumulate.

It is simply the space where the mind interacts with what is happening now.

In everyday life, a physical desk holds only the items needed for the current task.

Everything else stays in drawers, shelves, or notebooks.

This separation is not a rule—it is a natural response to how the mind works.

The Desktop in NDB follows the same principle.

It exists to support action, not to carry weight.

The Role of the Desktop

The Desktop represents the middle stage of thought: the point where ideas become decisions, and decisions become actions.

It is the bridge between the openness of the Notebook and the stability of the Bookshelf.

When the Desktop is clear, decisions become clear.

When the Desktop is heavy, thinking becomes heavy.

The Desktop is not a place to keep everything.

It is a place to keep only what is alive.

The Four States of Work

On the Desktop, information moves through four natural states:

- IN TRAY — things that have arrived
- ON DESK — things being worked on
- ON SIDE — things waiting
- FILED — things that are done

These states are not categories to maintain.

They are reflections of what the mind is doing.

IN TRAY

New items, incoming information, things that have not yet been examined.

The IN TRAY is not a place to store.

It is a place to notice.

ON DESK

Items currently being shaped or decided.

This is the true center of the Desktop—

the space where attention is active.

ON SIDE

Items that are waiting, paused, or dependent on something else.

They are not forgotten.

They are simply not active.

FILED

Items that have reached a natural stopping point.

They are complete enough to leave the Desktop.

These four states mirror the natural rhythm of work:

arrival, action, waiting, completion.

The Zero Gravity Desk

A desk becomes heavy when it holds information.

It becomes light when it holds only decisions.

The Zero Gravity Desk is the expression of this idea.

On a Zero Gravity Desk, nothing is stored.

The Desktop contains only shortcuts—pointers to items in the Notebook or Bookshelf.

The files themselves remain where they naturally belong.

The Desktop carries no weight.

This weightlessness supports thinking.

It keeps the mind from being pulled down by unfinished work, unmade decisions, or forgotten tasks.

A light desk creates a light mind.

Why the Desktop Must Stay Clear

The Desktop is the most fragile part of the system.

If it becomes crowded, the entire flow of thought slows down.

A heavy Desktop creates:

- hesitation
- confusion
- shallow decisions
- constant switching
- a sense of being behind

A clear Desktop creates:

- focus
- continuity
- calm decisions
- natural movement
- a sense of progress

The Desktop does not need to be perfect.

It only needs to stay light enough for thinking to move.

Movement on the Desktop

Information does not stay on the Desktop forever.

It moves.

- From IN TRAY to ON DESK when attention begins

- From ON DESK to ON SIDE when waiting begins
- From ON DESK to FILED when completion arrives
- From FILED to the Bookshelf when the idea settles
- From IN TRAY back to the Notebook when the idea is not ready

This movement is not managed.

It is noticed.

The Desktop does not control information.

It reflects it.

The Desktop in Daily Life

The Desktop is the most practical part of NDB.

It touches everyday life directly:

- reading a message
- writing a draft
- making a decision
- pausing a task
- finishing something small
- returning to something larger

These are ordinary actions.

The Desktop simply gives them a place.

When the Desktop is used gently,

work becomes easier.

Decisions become clearer.

The mind becomes lighter.

The Desktop is not a system to maintain.

It is a surface—

a surface where the present moment can be handled without
weight.

Chapter 5 — Bookshelf

The Bookshelf is the place where information comes to rest.

It is the quietest part of the system—

a space for knowledge that no longer needs active shaping,

no longer demands attention,

and no longer pulls on the mind.

In everyday life, shelves hold what has already been made,

learned, or completed.

They do not ask for decisions.

They simply keep things available for when they are needed again.

The Bookshelf in NDB follows the same principle.

It is not a place to manage.

It is a place to return to.

The Nature of Settled Information

Information does not remain active forever.

Ideas mature.

Projects finish.

Notes become stable.

What was once “living material” becomes quiet knowledge.

This shift is natural.

It happens slowly, without rules or schedules.

The Bookshelf exists to hold this settled information—
not as a storage system,
but as a long-term memory.

When information rests in the right place,
the mind rests with it.

The Four Layers of the Bookshelf

Information settles into layers, much like geological strata.
These layers reflect how often something changes,
how often it is referenced,
and how important it is over time.

The Bookshelf consists of four natural layers:

Works

High revision, high reference, medium importance.
Materials still in motion—drafts, developing ideas, evolving
documents.

Record

Medium revision, medium reference, medium importance.
Factual traces of what happened: logs, minutes, histories.

Reference

Low revision, medium reference, high importance.

Knowledge that supports thinking: manuals, guidelines, essential documents.

Archives

Low revision, low reference, high importance.

Completed work, confirmed data, long-term assets.

These layers are not rules.

They are the way information naturally settles over time.

The Bookshelf does not ask the user to maintain these layers.

It simply reflects the depth of memory.

Why the Bookshelf Matters

A well-kept Bookshelf does not feel organized.

It feels calm.

It gives the mind a sense of continuity—

a quiet assurance that nothing important is lost,
and nothing unfinished is hiding.

When the Bookshelf is clear,

the mind does not need to remember everything.

It can think about what is happening now.

This is the purpose of the Bookshelf:

to hold what the mind no longer needs to carry.

Naming on the Bookshelf

Names on the Bookshelf are simple.

They do not need to follow strict rules.

A typical structure might include:

- a sequence number
- a category
- a date (optional)

Examples:

Unlike Notebook items, Bookshelf items rarely begin with dates.

This makes the two layers easy to distinguish at a glance.

The goal is clarity, not precision.

The Bookshelf is a place for stability, not activity.

The Transition Principle

The movement from Notebook to Bookshelf is not a task.

It is a transition.

When an idea no longer needs active shaping,

it naturally shifts toward rest.

This is the Transition Principle:

information settles when it is ready.

The Bookshelf does not pull information in.

It receives it.

The Bookshelf in Daily Life

The Bookshelf is the most stable part of NDB.

It reflects how people naturally keep what matters:

- completed work
- important documents
- knowledge worth returning to
- traces of what happened
- things that should not be lost

These are not tasks.

They are memories.

When the Bookshelf is used gently,

life becomes easier to navigate.

There is less to remember,

less to manage,

and more room to think.

The Bookshelf is not a system.

It is a quiet place—

a place where knowledge can rest without weight.

Chapter 6 — The Flow of Thought

Thought does not move in straight lines.

It drifts, returns, pauses, and continues.

It begins loosely, becomes clearer through action, and eventually settles into memory.

The Flow of Thought is the natural movement of the mind when it is not interrupted or overloaded.

It is not a technique.

It is simply how thinking behaves when given space.

NDB does not create this flow.

It reveals it.

The Natural Movement of Thought

When the mind is calm, thought moves through three gentle stages:

- beginning
- shaping
- settling

These stages are not steps to follow.

They are the way ideas naturally unfold.

An idea begins as a fragment.

It becomes clearer when handled.

It becomes stable when left alone.

This movement is quiet, slow, and continuous.

It cannot be rushed, and it cannot be forced.

The Flow of Thought is the rhythm of this movement.

How NDB Mirrors the Flow

NDB's three layers—Notebook, Desktop, and Bookshelf—exist because they match the natural stages of thought.

Notebook → beginning

Ideas appear without structure.

They need space, not order.

Desktop → shaping

Ideas are handled, shaped, and decided.

They need clarity, not storage.

Bookshelf → settling

Ideas become knowledge.

They need rest, not attention.

NDB does not impose these stages.

It reflects them.

When information is placed in environments that match these movements,

the mind no longer needs to manage the process.

It simply follows it.

Continuity Without Effort

The Flow of Thought is continuous when the environment does not interrupt it.

Interruptions break continuity.

Friction slows it.

Unnecessary decisions scatter it.

But when the Notebook is light,

when the Desktop is clear,

when the Bookshelf is calm,

thought moves naturally.

The mind does not need to remember everything.

It only needs to know where things belong.

This is the quiet foundation of NDB.

The Role of the Transition Principle

The Transition Principle describes the moment when thought shifts from one stage to another.

- When an idea becomes active, it moves to the Desktop.
- When it becomes stable, it moves to the Bookshelf.
- When it becomes quiet, it stays there.

This movement is not managed.

It is noticed.

The Transition Principle is the bridge between stages—
the moment when the mind recognizes that something has
changed.

It is the most subtle part of NDB,
and the most natural.

The Flow in Daily Life

The Flow of Thought is not a concept.

It is something people experience every day:

- a thought appears
- it becomes clearer through action
- it becomes quiet when finished
- it becomes memory when needed again

NDB does not change this flow.

It supports it.

When the environment matches the mind,
thinking becomes easier.

Decisions become calmer.

Life becomes lighter.

The Flow of Thought is already present in everyone.

NDB simply gives it room to move.

A Quiet Conclusion

The Flow of Thought is the heart of the Natural Brain.

It is the movement that connects beginning, action, and rest.

When the mind is not overloaded,

this flow becomes continuous.

Ideas grow naturally.

Decisions become clear.

Knowledge settles without effort.

The purpose of NDB is not to control this flow,

but to protect it.

When the environment supports the mind,

the Natural Brain reappears—

quiet, steady, and fully alive.

Appendix A — System Map

This appendix provides an overview of the broader NAW ecosystem.

Some items do not appear in this volume, but are included to show the full structure of the series and how the ideas relate to one another.

Brand / Organization

- NAW (Natural Architecture Works)

The overarching project exploring natural human–information interaction.

- NIL (Natural Intelligence Lab)

A research space for developing and refining conceptual frameworks.

- Natural Brain (NDB)

The practical, everyday expression of NAW’s values.

Books

- NAW Human Interface Framework

A conceptual foundation for future interfaces.

- NAW Natural Brain (NDB I)

The book you are reading—focused on natural thinking environments.

- NAW Natural Brain II (NDB II)

Internal research materials; not published as a standalone book.

Concepts

- Origin of the 1-1-1 Folder Method
- Zero Gravity Desk
- Layered Knowledge Shelf
- Flow of Thought
- The Transition Principle
- Cognitive Load

NDB Structure (Names Only)

- NOTEBOOK
- PREVIOUS
- CURRENT
- DESKTOP
- IN TRAY
- ON DESK
- ON SIDE
- FILED
- BOOKSHELF
- WORKS
- RECORD
- REFERENCE
- ARCHIVES

These names represent the natural environments through which information moves.

Appendix B — Technical Parallels and Background Concepts

This appendix introduces several technical concepts that share similarities with the ideas in this book.

They are not required to understand the main text.

They are included for readers who wish to explore how traditional, human-centered practices relate to modern information-management theory.

1. Single Source of Truth (SSOT)

In data management, SSOT refers to maintaining one authoritative version of information.

While NDB does not rely on SSOT as a formal concept, the intention is similar:

- one place to return to
- one continuous line of thought
- one record that reflects the current state of an idea

The 1-1-1 Folder Method predates SSOT, but both aim to reduce fragmentation.

2. Version Continuity

Modern systems often track multiple versions of a file.

This can be useful, but it can also increase cognitive load.

The One Master File approach offers a simpler alternative:

a single evolving document that carries the history of an idea forward—

much like traditional notebooks and manuscripts.

3. Information Architecture (IA)

IA studies how information is structured and navigated.

The Notebook–Desktop–Bookshelf model aligns with IA's emphasis on:

- clear boundaries
- predictable locations
- reduced friction

The difference is that NDB focuses on human pace, not system optimization.

4. Project and Knowledge Management Systems

Many modern frameworks attempt to organize tasks and knowledge.

They can be powerful, but often require ongoing maintenance.

NDB takes a different approach:

it relies on traditional spatial metaphors—notes, desks, shelves—which remain intuitive across time.

5. Digital Minimalism and Cognitive Load Theory

Research suggests the mind performs best when unnecessary complexity is removed.

Digital minimalism echoes this idea.

NDB shares the same intention,

but arises from everyday experience rather than academic theory.

Closing Note

These technical parallels are optional background.

The methods in this book stand on their own,
rooted in natural human behavior rather than formal systems.
Readers do not need to understand SSOT, IA, or version control
to benefit from the Notebook–Desktop–Bookshelf model
or the 1-1-1 Folder Method.

The appendix simply shows that
what feels natural to humans often aligns with principles
that modern systems rediscover in more complex forms.

Afterword

The ideas in this book did not appear all at once.

They grew slowly—through years of writing, working, and noticing when thinking felt natural and when it did not.

Much of modern life asks the mind to move faster than it comfortably can.

Yet clarity rarely comes from speed.

It comes from space, rhythm, and environments that do not pull on attention.

The Natural Brain is not something to create.

It is something to uncover.

If this book has helped you notice the conditions under which your mind works well—

even in small moments—

then its purpose has been fulfilled.

Thank you for spending this quiet time with these ideas.

May your thinking move gently, and may your days feel a little lighter.

Author's Note

This book began as a collection of observations—
notes written late at night,
unfinished thoughts in folders,
and reflections on why some environments felt calm while others
felt heavy.

Over time, these fragments formed a pattern.

The pattern became a structure.

And the structure became this book.

The Natural Brain is not a method.

It is a way of seeing the mind with kindness—
not as something to optimize,
but as something to support.

I hope these pages offer a sense of ease,
and perhaps a reminder that thinking does not need to be forced.
It only needs room.

— S. Hara

Future Directions

The ideas in this book are part of a larger exploration of how people interact with information.

Two directions continue from here:

1. NAW Human Interface Framework

A conceptual foundation for future interfaces—
focused on natural interaction, cognitive clarity, and
environments that adapt to the mind.

2. NAW Homepage

A public space where the values of both books—
the Natural Brain and the Human Interface Framework—
are brought together and shared with the world.

These projects extend the same question that shaped this book:

How can our environments support the mind,
rather than demand more from it?

The exploration continues, quietly and steadily.

About the Author

S. Hara is an information architect and writer exploring how people think, work, and interact with information in everyday life.

His work focuses on natural structures—
arrangements that support the mind without forcing it—
and on designing environments that remain clear, calm, and
sustainable over time.

He writes in both Japanese and English,
and develops conceptual frameworks that connect traditional
ways of working
with the needs of modern digital life.

The Natural Brain is part of a broader project
that includes the NAW Human Interface Framework
and the NAW Homepage,
which together explore how human thought and digital
environments
can coexist more naturally.